Wesley Kay

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 8+ years product design across web and mobile, with a portfolio of 0→1 products taken from concept to launch and enterprise systems taken to 40M+ users
- Design systems at three companies: built Qualcomm's first system from scratch (visual direction, principles, governance for a 1,500+ icon library across three brands, built on Lucide), lead the visual design of the system behind BNY's enterprise AI platform, and on T-Mobile's design system team built components, drove adoption, and ran the research that fed the system
- Co-founded a DeFi protocol to make on-chain trading usable by non-experts; led design and operations for a 25-person org through a $4M seed and 0→100K+ community
- Drives visual design direction for an enterprise AI platform at BNY, from the product surface through the design system components every team inherits
- Designs and prototypes in code, shipping in shared repos with engineers; senior leadership calls on me for production-ready prototypes for CEO-level review, delivered within 24 hours
- Works in high ambiguity and holds a point of view: defined two platform frameworks adopted org-wide, and built my own research loop when none was handed to me
- Toolkit: Claude Code, Codex, Figma, HTML/CSS, Git/GitLab, Adobe Suite

PRODUCT DESIGN & 0→1 EXPERIENCE

BNY
Oct 2025 – Present

Senior (Staff) AI Design Lead

- Lead the visual design of the design system behind an enterprise AI platform serving 40K employees, the foundation every product area inherits: set its initial visual direction, drive component-level decisions across it, and pitched and shipped light mode in three days after selling it to the Head of Design
- Built a component explorer app for full ideation range, resulting in increased velocity of component decisions and shipping out across multiple products
- Pushed the system's component strategy toward an architecture agents can consume: larger semantic components with explicit usage contracts rather than compositional primitives, because generated UI needs rules it can follow instead of documentation to read
- Own the experience through which every employee at the bank works with Eliza AI. The top nav had run out of room as the bank kept adding AI products, so I replaced it with a unified IA and a front door for the whole platform. Launched March 2026, shipped bank-wide July 2026. Also own the agent marketplace end-to-end
- Every new AI product at the bank kept relitigating the same two questions, so I defined the frameworks that settled them: where a product lives (native, integrated, external) and how work reaches a user (self-created, assigned, AI-proposed). Both adopted; every downstream product inherits them
- Run research for the core experience: study design, recruiting, and 1:1 sessions on a standing cadence. Those sessions have reversed decisions I had already committed to

Qualcomm
Feb 2025 – Sept 2025

Senior (Staff) Product Designer · Design Systems Lead

- Built an AI-in-the-loop documentation workflow with 120x less writing effort and 95% less CMS time, resulting in all 60+ design system components documented on schedule for enterprise beta
- Direction setting for Qualcomm's first design system: wrote the design principles the rest of the team built from, defined UX patterns, and responsible for a 1,500+ icon system built on Lucide, unifying marketing and product across three brands, now public at react.qui.qualcomm.com
- Defined what a UX pattern *is* for the system. Original research, peer benchmarking and validated against shipping products. Presented to Heads of Design for buy-in
- Designed the documentation architecture, then the contribution and review workflow that let a team spread across time zones add to the system without it fragmenting

Autonomy / Overlay Sept 2021 – Feb 2025
Co-Founder, Head of Design

- Took a DeFi protocol from zero to one. Owned all visual design, UX, branding, and design language across web app, mobile, and marketing site, through four full app iterations
- Built the visual identity from nothing: logo, mascot, design ethos document, and a component library that let a distributed team ship without me in the room
- Grew community 0 → 100K+ (77K Twitter, 50K Discord), shipped 12 products, and built the team from 3 to 25
- Raised and managed a $4M seed, owning investor relationships and a $3.4M budget across four regulatory jurisdictions

T-Mobile Feb 2020 – Sept 2021
Senior UX Designer, Lead

- Design lead for Global Navigation, rolling out multiple changes to 30+ LOBs for 40M monthly active users across web and mobile
- Design lead for Search, reducing the share of searches with zero results from ~13% to 0.7%
- On the design system team for a system serving 40+ designers: built and contributed components, socialized it across product teams, trained designers on how to apply it, and ran usability research on the system itself so adoption problems came back as fixes
- Ran research end-to-end so the deadline held without designing blind: wrote the questions, briefed in-house researchers and outside vendors, translated findings into direction

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Field Design Co. Jun 2023 – Feb 2025
Principal Designer, Founder

- Unlimited design subscription for early-stage startups. 2x sales for a client via UX improvements; cut iteration cycles 25-35%

Toptender 2019
UI/UX Consultant

Opolis 2018 – 2019
UI/UX Designer

- Blockchain employment ecosystem, with dual PM responsibilities

SELECTED SIDE PROJECTS

- **sketch-to-revit** (2026) · 0→1 AI tool that turns hand-drawn architectural sketches into a multi-storey IFC BIM model openable in Revit or ArchiCAD. Multi-image vision reconciliation, structured output, IFC geometry generated programmatically. Solo design + build, in alpha with an architect
- **Iona Tracker** (2026) · Self-hosted PWA for tracking newborn activity across caregivers. Solo design + build (Node, Express, SQLite, Cloudflare Tunnel). Running daily in my own home

EDUCATION

Master of Architecture · University of Colorado Denver · 2014–2017
B.A. Environmental Studies, cum laude · University of Colorado Boulder · 2008–2010

SKILLS

Visual & Interaction: Visual systems for new products, iconography, brand-to-product translation, typography, motion, prototyping
Design Systems: Component patterns, tokens, governance, multi-brand scaling, AI-consumable foundations
Product Design: 0→1 greenfield, end-to-end domain ownership, mobile and web, high-ambiguity exploration
Prototyping in Code: Claude Code, Codex, HTML/CSS, shared-repo collaboration with engineers, MCP
Research: Independent qualitative research, interview synthesis, usability testing, A/B validation